

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Why Are We All So Stressed?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Overwhelm is described as an _____ linked to difficulty dealing with life.
2	A person may feel unable to handle their _____.
3	They might feel _____, as if too much is happening at once.
4	They may also feel they _____ with the pressure.
5	If the feeling lasts, it can become a form of _____.
6	Over time, this may finally lead to _____.
7	In exams, feeling stressed may not always be harmful; _____ can sharpen performance.
8	According to the advice, nerves may help students _____.
9	A realistic first step is accepting that a _____ will never completely disappear.
10	Having new tasks every day can simply be a sign of a _____.

11 **How is "overwhelm" defined in the extract?**

- A A permanent illness caused by too much studying.
- B A state of struggling with the situation one is facing.
- C A short period of happiness after finishing tasks.
- D A habit of avoiding all difficult responsibilities.

12 **What risk is mentioned if overwhelm continues for a long time?**

- A It may make people lose interest in all work immediately.
- B It may turn into a useful source of motivation.
- C It may stop people from feeling temporary pressure.
- D It may develop into chronic stress and eventually burnout.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What surprising point is made about stress during an exam?**
- A It may help some students perform better by focusing their mind.
 - B It should be removed completely before students begin writing.
 - C It usually makes students forget what they have learned.
 - D It is useful only when the exam is not important.
- 14 **How do the speakers present "nerves" after the exam-stress advice?**
- A As a sign that students have failed to prepare.
 - B As a problem that only affects actors and athletes.
 - C As worry that can sometimes support clearer thinking.
 - D As a feeling that should be ignored during performance.
- 15 **What does the exchange suggest about advice for feeling overwhelmed?**
- A There is one method that works best for everyone.
 - B Different people may need different ways to handle it.
 - C General stress can only be solved by finishing work faster.
 - D The best solution is to stop making plans completely.
- 16 **What is Claudia's first piece of general advice?**
- A Complete every task before starting another one.
 - B Keep the to-do list short by avoiding difficult tasks.
 - C Treat tomorrow's tasks as more important than today's.
 - D Accept that the to-do list will continue to exist.
- 17 **Why does Claudia say her advice "might sound defeatist"?**
- A She realises accepting an endless list may sound negative.
 - B She wants people to give up all their responsibilities.
 - C She believes stress has no possible solution.
 - D She is warning that busy people cannot be happy.
- 18 **What is implied by the idea that tomorrow will bring more tasks?**
- A Most tasks are unnecessary and should be deleted.
 - B People should finish tomorrow's tasks today.
 - C A continuing to-do list is a normal part of a busy life.
 - D Stress mainly comes from poor time-management skills.

19 **Why does Neil suggest people should not stress too much about their to-do list?**

- A Because written lists are less useful than memory.
- B Because new tasks will keep appearing anyway.
- C Because most tasks are easier than they look.
- D Because stress disappears when people work harder.

20 **Which broader message best matches the later advice on managing stress?**

- A Stress can be avoided only by lowering all ambitions.
- B The best method is to use the same routine every day.
- C People should judge themselves by perfect productivity.
- D Managing stress can involve acceptance rather than total control.